Fundamentally, this is the rejection of the views that what we experience is not physical objects but ideas in our minds, and that our perceptions of reality are just subjective interpretations.

See ***sakara-vada***

Further reading: Kajiyama 1998; Matilal 1986; Mohanty 1992

Nirguna (featureless Absolute Being): ***Advaita-Vedanta*** tenet that the foundation of reality (***Brahman***) is an impersonal and indescribable conscious principle utterly devoid of any differentiating features or actions. The soul within everyone is identical with this formless reality. Intuitive realisation of this identity is the goal of purely mental spiritual discipline. Belief in the ultimate reality of any form of individuality and agency is mistaken.

Nirukta (*Nirvacana-shastra*): the meanings of many of the words in the ancient *Vedic* scriptures were obscure. The *Nirukta* tradition developed techniques for explaining these problematic words, which were widely deployed whenever some explanation of a term was called for. The view was that meanings were basically related to actions. Actions are signified by verbs. Nouns stand for aspects of events. The meaning of a noun derives from the meanings of verbs. The sounds of a word are the vehicles of its core meaning. The meaning of a problematic word may be understood from its grammatical formation and role in a context. But where this does not help, comparison between the sounds found in a word and the same sounds as found in verbs can reveal the meaning of a noun.

Examples: In ***Abhidharma*** Buddhism, the noun ***dharma*** stands for the basically real mental and material atomic factors. This is explained as ***svalakshana*** (its own unique feature) – *dharanad* (by supporting). *Dharanad* is